Text 1

第 1 段

If you intend using humor in your talk to make people smile, you must know how to identify shared experiences and problems. Your humor must be relevant to the audience and should help to show them that you are one of them or that you understand their situation and are in sympathy with their point of view. Depending on whom you are addressing, the problems will be different. If you are talking to a group of managers, you may refer to the disorganized methods of their secretaries; alternatively if you are addressing secretaries, you may want to comment on their disorganized bosses.

直译：如果你打算在讲话中运用幽默使人发笑，就必须懂得如何识别共同的经历和问题。你的幽默必须与听众相关，并应帮助他们看出，你是他们中的一员，或者你理解他们的处境，并认同他们的观点。问题会因你所面对的听众而异。如果你对一群经理讲话，可以提及他们秘书杂乱无章的工作方法；反过来，如果你对秘书讲话，就可以评论他们办事没有条理的上司。

第 2 段

Here is an example, which I heard at a nurses' convention, of a story which works well because the audience all shared the same view of doctors. A man arrives in heaven and is being shown around by St. Peter. He sees wonderful accommodations, beautiful gardens, sunny weather, and so on. Everyone is very peaceful, polite and friendly until, waiting in a line for lunch, the new arrival is suddenly pushed aside by a man in a white coat, who rushes to the head of the line, grabs his food and stomps over to a table by himself. "Who is that?" the new arrival asked St. Peter. "Oh, that's God," came the reply, "but sometimes he thinks he's a doctor."

直译：这里有一个我在护士大会上听到的故事，它之所以效果很好，是因为听众对医生有相同看法。一个人来到天堂，圣彼得正带他四处参观。他看见优美的住处、美丽的花园、晴朗的天气等等。每个人都十分平和、礼貌、友好，直到排队吃午饭时，这个新来的人突然被一个穿白大褂的人推到一边；那人冲到队伍最前头，抓起食物，独自重重地走到一张桌子旁。新来的人问圣彼得："那是谁？"回答是："哦，那是上帝，不过有时他以为自己是医生。"

第 3 段

If you are part of the group which you are addressing, you will be in a position to know the experiences and problems which are common to all of you and it'll be appropriate for you to make a passing remark about the inedible canteen food or the chairman's notorious bad taste in ties. With other audiences you mustn't attempt to cut in with humor as they will resent an outsider making disparaging remarks about their canteen or their chairman. You will be on safer ground if you stick to scapegoats like the Post Office or the telephone system.

直译：如果你就是听众群体中的一员，你就能够知道大家共同的经历和问题；这时，顺口评论食堂难以下咽的饭菜，或主席挑选领带时出了名的糟糕品味，就是合适的。面对其他听众时，你不能试图以这样的幽默插入讲话，因为他们会反感一个外人贬低自己的食堂或主席。如果你坚持拿邮局或电话系统之类的替罪羊开玩笑，就会更稳妥。

第 4 段

If you feel awkward being humorous, you must practice so that it becomes more natural. Include a few casual and apparently off-the-cuff remarks which you can deliver in a relaxed and unforced manner. Often it's the delivery which causes the audience to smile, so speak slowly and remember that a raised eyebrow or an unbelieving look may help to show that you are making a light-hearted remark.

直译：如果你在幽默表达时感到别扭，就必须练习，使它变得更自然。可以加入几句随意、看似即兴的话，并以放松、不勉强的方式说出来。常常是表达方式使听众微笑，因此要慢慢说；记住，扬一下眉毛或露出不相信的神情，都可能帮助表明你是在说一句轻松的玩笑话。

第 5 段

Look for the humor. It often comes from the unexpected. A twist on a familiar quote "If at first you don't succeed, give up" or a play on words or on a situation. Search for exaggeration and understatement. Look at your talk and pick out a few words or sentences which you can turn about and inject with humor.

直译：去寻找幽默。它往往来自出乎意料之处：改动一句熟悉的引语，例如 " 如果起初没有成功，那就放弃 "；或者玩一个文字游戏，或在某种情境上做文章。寻找夸张和轻描淡写的表达。审视自己的讲话，挑出几个可以转变说法、注入幽默的词语或句子。

篇章简析

主旨：有效的演讲幽默取决于共同背景、恰当对象和自然表达。第 2 段笑点在倒置 " 医生像上帝 " 的自负印象；并非真的讨论宗教。第 3 段 outsider 与 part of the group 对照，解释同一笑话为何因听众不同而效果相反。

Text 2

第 1 段

Since the dawn of human ingenuity, people have devised ever more cunning tools to cope with work that is dangerous, boring, burdensome, or just plain nasty. That compulsion has resulted in robotics—the science of conferring various human capabilities on machines. And if scientists have yet to create the mechanical version of science fiction, they have begun to come close.

直译：自人类创造才能初现以来，人们就不断设计出更巧妙的工具，以应对危险、乏味、繁重或纯粹令人厌恶的工作。这种强烈的驱动力促成了机器人学，即把人类各种能力赋予机器的科学。即使科学家尚未创造出科幻作品所描绘的机械世界，他们也已经开始接近这一目标。

第 2 段

As a result, the modern world is increasingly populated by intelligent gizmos whose presence we barely notice but whose universal existence has removed much human labor. Our factories hum to the rhythm of robot assembly arms. Our banking is done at automated teller terminals that thank us with mechanical politeness for the transaction. Our subway trains are controlled by tireless robot-drivers. And thanks to the continual miniaturization of electronics and micro-mechanics, there are already robot systems that can perform some kinds of brain and bone surgery with submillimeter accuracy— far greater precision than highly skilled physicians can achieve with their hands alone.

直译：因此，现代世界中越来越多地出现智能小装置，我们几乎注意不到它们的存在，但它们的普遍存在已替代了许多人类劳动。工厂随着机器人装配臂的节奏嗡嗡运转。我们的银行业务在自动柜员机终端办理，机器以机械的礼貌感谢我们的交易。地铁列车由不知疲倦的机器人驾驶员控制。而且，由于电子技术与微型机械不断小型化，已经有机器人系统能够以小于一毫米的精度完成某些脑部和骨科手术，这远比技术娴熟的医生仅凭双手所能达到的精度高。

第 3 段

But if robots are to reach the next stage of laborsaving utility, they will have to operate with less human supervision and be able to make at least a few decisions for themselves— goals that pose a real challenge. “While we know how to tell a robot to handle a specific error,” says Dave Lavery, manager of a robotics program at NASA, “we can’t yet give a robot enough ‘common sense’ to reliably interact with a dynamic world.”

直译：但如果机器人要进入节省劳动的新阶段，就必须在更少的人类监督下工作，并至少能够自主作出少量决定；这些目标构成了真正的挑战。美国国家航空航天局机器人项目负责人戴夫·莱弗里说：“虽然我们知道如何让机器人处理某种特定错误，但我们还无法赋予机器人足够的‘常识’，让它可靠地与不断变化的世界互动。”

第 4 段

Indeed the quest for true artificial intelligence has produced very mixed results. Despite a spell of initial optimism in the 1960s and 1970s when it appeared that transistor circuits and microprocessors might be able to copy the action of the human brain by the year 2010, researchers lately have begun to extend that forecast by decades if not centuries.

直译：事实上，追求真正人工智能所取得的结果好坏参半。20 世纪 60 和 70 年代曾有过一段最初的乐观时期，当时看来，晶体管电路和微处理器也许到 2010 年就能模拟人脑活动；但近来，研究者开始把这一预测的实现时间向后推迟，即使不是几百年，也至少是几十年。

第 5 段

What they found, in attempting to model thought, is that the human brain's roughly one hundred billion nerve cells are much more talented— and human perception far more complicated — than previously imagined. They have built robots that can recognize the error of a machine panel by a fraction of a millimeter in a controlled factory environment. But the human mind can glimpse a rapidly changing scene and immediately disregard the 98 percent that is irrelevant, instantaneously focusing on the monkey at the side of a winding forest road or the single suspicious face in a big crowd. The most advanced computer systems on Earth can't approach that kind of ability, and neuroscientists still don't know quite how we do it.

直译：他们在尝试模拟思维时发现，人脑约一千亿个神经细胞的能力，比此前想象的强大得多；人类感知也复杂得多。他们已经造出了能够在受控工厂环境中识别机械面板几分之一毫米误差的机器人。但人脑只需瞥一眼快速变化的场景，就能立刻忽略 98% 的无关信息，瞬间聚焦于弯曲林间道路旁的猴子，或一大群人中唯一一张可疑的面孔。地球上最先进的计算机系统都无法接近这种能力，而神经科学家仍不完全知道我们是怎样做到的。

篇章简析

主旨：机器在特定任务上表现出色，但自主决策、常识及复杂感知仍是文章所讨论的难点。第 5 段以精密工厂任务与日常视觉筛选形成对比。if not centuries 在此为递进，即 " 即使不是几百年，也有几十年 "。本文技术状态与预测按历史原文理解。

Text 3

第 1 段

Could the bad old days of economic decline be about to return? Since OPEC agreed to supply-cuts in March, the price of crude oil has jumped to almost $26 a barrel, up from less than $10 last December. This near-tripling of oil prices calls up scary memories of the 1973 oil shock, when prices quadrupled, and 1979-1980, when they also almost tripled. Both previous shocks resulted in double-digit inflation and global economic decline. So where are the headlines warning of gloom and doom this time?

直译：经济衰退的糟糕旧日子会不会即将重来？自欧佩克 3 月同意削减供应以来，原油价格已从去年 12 月每桶不到 10 美元跃升至近 26 美元。这种接近三倍的油价上涨，唤起了人们对 1973 年石油冲击的可怕记忆：当时价格涨至四倍；而在 1979—1980 年，油价也几乎涨至三倍。此前两次冲击都导致了两位数通货膨胀和全球经济衰退。那么，这一次警告经济惨淡和灾难将至的头条新闻在哪里呢?

第 2 段

The oil price was given another push up this week when Iraq suspended oil exports. Strengthening economic growth, at the same time as winter grips the northern hemisphere, could push the price higher still in the short term.

直译：本周，伊拉克暂停石油出口，使油价再次上升。经济增长加强，同时寒冬笼罩北半球，可能使短期内油价进一步上涨。

第 3 段

Yet there are good reasons to expect the economic consequences now to be less severe than in the 1970s. In most countries the cost of crude oil now accounts for a smaller share of the price of petrol than it did in the 1970s. In Europe, taxes account for up to four-fifths of the retail price, so even quite big changes in the price of crude have a more muted effect on pump prices than in the past.

直译：然而，有充分理由预计，如今的经济后果会比 20 世纪 70 年代轻。在大多数国家，原油成本占汽油价格的比例，已经低于 70 年代。在欧洲，税收占零售价格的比例高达五分之四，因此，即使原油价格变化相当大，对加油站价格的影响也比过去小。

第 4 段

Rich economies are also less dependent on oil than they were, and so less sensitive to swings in the oil price. Energy conservation, a shift to other fuels and a decline in the importance of heavy, energy-intensive industries have reduced oil consumption. Software, consultancy and mobile telephones use far less oil than steel or car production. For each dollar of GDP (in constant prices) rich economies now use nearly 50% less oil than in 1973. The OECD estimates in its latest Economic Outlook that, if oil prices averaged $22 a barrel for a full year, compared with $13 in 1998, this would increase the oil import bill in rich economies by only 0.25-0.5% of GDP. That is less than one-quarter of the income loss in 1974 or 1980. On the other hand, oil-importing emerging economies—to which heavy industry has shifted— have become more energy-intensive, and so could be more seriously squeezed.

直译：富裕经济体对石油的依赖也较过去降低，因此对油价波动不那么敏感。节能、转向其他燃料，以及高耗能重工业重要性的下降，都减少了石油消耗。软件、咨询和移动电话所消耗的石油，远少于钢铁或汽车生产。按不变价格计算，富裕经济体如今每创造一美元 GDP，所用石油比 1973 年少了近 50%。经合组织在最新《经济展望》中估计，如果油价全年平均为每桶 22 美元，而 1998 年为 13 美元，那么富裕经济体新增的石油进口支出只相当于 GDP 的 0.25%—0.5%。这不到 1974 年或 1980 年收入损失的四分之一。另一方面，重工业转入的那些石油进口型新兴经济体，已经变得更加耗能，因此可能受到更严重的挤压。

第 5 段

One more reason not to lose sleep over the rise in oil prices is that, unlike the rises in the 1970s, it has not occurred against the background of general commodity-price inflation and global excess demand. A sizable portion of the world is only just emerging from economic decline. The Economist's commodity price index is broadly unchanging from a year ago. In 1973 commodity prices jumped by 70%, and in 1979 by almost 30%.

直译：还有一个不必因油价上涨而失眠的理由：这次上涨不像 70 年代那样，发生在商品价格普遍上涨和全球需求过剩的背景下。世界上相当大一部分地区才刚刚走出经济衰退。《经济学人》的商品价格指数与一年前相比基本未变。而在 1973 年，商品价格上涨了 70%；1979 年则上涨了近 30%。

篇章简析

主旨：油价上涨未必重演 70 年代危机，因为税负结构、能耗强度和全球需求背景已变化。第 4 段分别讨论富裕经济体与新兴经济体，不能把前者结论推广到全部国家。increase ... by ... of GDP 指新增支出占 GDP 的比例，不是油价涨幅。

Text 4

第 1 段

The Supreme Court's decisions on physician-assisted suicide carry important implications for how medicine seeks to relieve dying patients of pain and suffering.

直译：最高法院有关医生协助自杀的判决，对医疗如何帮助临终患者减轻疼痛和痛苦具有重要影响。

第 2 段

Although it ruled that there is no constitutional right to physician-assisted suicide, the Court in effect supported the medical principle of "double effect", a centuries-old moral principle holding that an action having two effects—a good one that is intended and a harmful one that is foreseen—is permissible if the actor intends only the good effect.

直译：虽然法院裁定，宪法并不赋予人们获得医生协助自杀的权利，但它实际上支持了医学上的“双重效果”原则。这是一项已有数百年历史的道德原则：如果某一行为有两种效果，一种是行为者意图实现的良好效果，另一种是可以预见的有害效果，那么只要行为者仅意图实现良好效果，这一行为就是可允许的。

第 3 段

Doctors have used that principle in recent years to justify using high doses of morphine to control terminally ill patients' pain, even though increasing dosages will eventually kill the patient.

直译：近些年，医生利用这一原则，为使用高剂量吗啡控制绝症患者疼痛的做法辩护，即便增加剂量最终会使患者死亡。

第 4 段

Nancy Dubler, director of Montefiore Medical Center, contends that the principle will shield doctors who "until now have very, very strongly insisted that they could not give patients sufficient medication to control their pain if that might hasten death".

直译：蒙特菲奥里医疗中心主任南希·杜布勒主张，这一原则将保护那些医生；他们“直到现在还一直非常坚决地表示，如果充分用药控制疼痛可能加速死亡，他们就不能给患者足够的药物”。

第 5 段

George Annas, chair of the health law department at Boston University, maintains that, as long as a doctor prescribes a drug for a legitimate medical purpose, the doctor has done nothing illegal even if the patient uses the drug to hasten death. "It's like surgery," he says. "We don't call those deaths homicides because the doctors didn't intend to kill their patients, although they risked their death. If you're a physician, you can risk your patient's suicide as long as you don't intend their suicide."

直译：波士顿大学卫生法系主任乔治·安纳斯认为，只要医生为正当医疗目的开药，即使患者利用该药加速死亡，医生也没有做任何违法的事。他说：“这就像手术。我们不把那些死亡称作杀人，因为医生虽然冒了患者死亡的风险，却并不想杀死患者。如果你是一名医生，只要你并不以患者自杀为目的，就可以承担患者可能自杀的风险。”

第 6 段

On another level, many in the medical community acknowledge that the assisted-suicide debate has been fueled in part by the despair of patients for whom modern medicine has prolonged the physical agony of dying.

直译：从另一个层面看，许多医学界人士承认，协助自杀的争论部分是由患者的绝望推动的：对这些患者而言，现代医学延长了临终时身体上的剧痛。

第 7 段

Just three weeks before the Court's ruling on physician-assisted suicide, the National Academy of Science (NAS) released a two-volume report, Approaching Death: Improving Care at the End of Life. It identifies the undertreatment of pain and the aggressive use of "ineffectual and forced medical procedures that may prolong and even dishonor the period of dying" as the twin problems of end-of-life care.

直译：就在法院对医生协助自杀作出裁决前三周，美国国家科学院发布了一份两卷本报告《走近死亡：改善生命终末期照护》。报告把镇痛不足，以及强行大量使用 " 无效而勉强施加的医疗程序，这些程序可能延长、甚至使临终阶段失去尊严 "，确定为临终照护的两大问题。

第 8 段

The profession is taking steps to require young doctors to train in hospices, to test knowledge of aggressive pain management therapies, to develop a Medicare billing code for hospital-based care, and to develop new standards for assessing and treating pain at the end of life.

直译：医学界正采取措施，要求年轻医生在临终关怀机构接受训练，考查积极疼痛管理疗法的知识，制定用于医院内照护的医疗保险结算代码，并建立评估和治疗生命终末期疼痛的新标准。

第 9 段

Annas says lawyers can play a key role in insisting that these well-meaning medical initiatives translate into better care. "Large numbers of physicians seem unconcerned with the pain their patients are needlessly and predictably suffering", to the extent that it constitutes "systematic patient abuse". He says medical licensing boards "must make it clear...that painful deaths are presumptively ones that are incompetently managed and should result in license suspension".

直译：安纳斯说，律师可以发挥关键作用，坚持要求这些出于善意的医疗举措转化为更好的照护。" 许多医生似乎并不关心患者正在不必要地、可预见地承受的疼痛 "，严重到构成 " 系统性的患者虐待 "。他说，医疗执照管理委员会 " 必须明确……应推定痛苦的死亡属于处置不当的死亡，并应因此暂停有关医生的执照 "。

篇章简析

主旨：以历史司法判决引出临终镇痛和照护不足，呼吁将原则转化为改善。双重效果原则中的 " 预见 " 与 " 意图 " 必须区分；末段是安纳斯主张，不是文章确认已经实施的处罚规则。文中的医学与法律讨论均按历史文章的观点和语境理解。

整理说明：依据所附年度试卷提取 Text 1–Text 4；每段英文后接中文直译。已修复明显断词、粘连、错字和标点损坏。文中数据、事件及观点均置于原文章的历史语境中理解。篇章简析为本次整理所加。